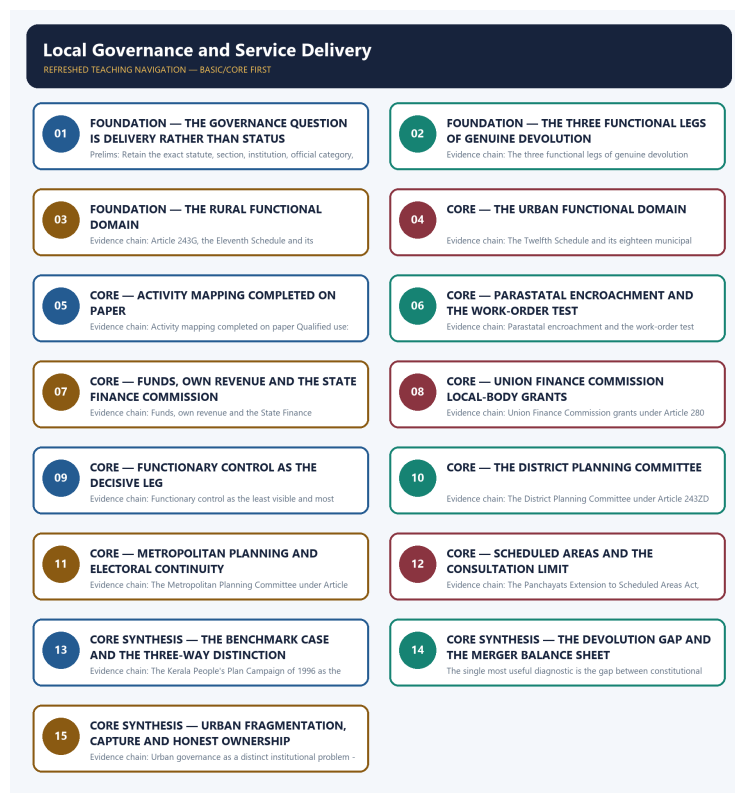


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Local Governance and Service Delivery - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Local Governance and Service Delivery - Solved Practice Workbook 6

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 6

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?	6
Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?	6
Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?	7
Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?	7
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The three functional legs of genuine devolution?	8
Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The three functional legs of genuine devolution?	8
Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The three functional legs of genuine devolution?	9
Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The three functional legs of genuine devolution?	9
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?	10
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?	10
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?	11
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?	11
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?	12
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?	12
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?	13
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?	13
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Activity mapping completed on paper?	14
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Activity mapping completed on paper?	14
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Activity mapping completed on paper?	15
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Activity mapping completed on paper?	15
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?	16
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?	16
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?	17
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?	17
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?	18

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?	18
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?	19
Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?	19
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?	20
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?	20
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?	21
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?	21
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?	22
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?	22
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?	23
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?	23
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?	24
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?	24
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?	25
Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?	25
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?	26
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?	26
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?	27
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?	27
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?	28
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?	28
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?	29
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?	29
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?	30
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?	30
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?	31
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?	31
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?	32
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?	32

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?	33
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?	33
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?	34
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?	35
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?	35
Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?	36
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?	37
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?	37
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?	38
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?	39
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies The case for rural and urban merger?	39
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under The case for rural and urban merger?	40
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The case for rural and urban merger?	41
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The case for rural and urban merger?	41
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The case against merger and the middle options?	42
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under The case against merger and the middle options?	43
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The case against merger and the middle options?	43
Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The case against merger and the middle options?	44
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?	45
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?	45
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?	46
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?	47
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?	47
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?	48
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?	49
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?	49

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 50

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	50
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	51
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II	54
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II	56

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II	58
PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2021 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I	60
PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2022 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I	62
PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2026 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I	63
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	65
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	67
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	69
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	71
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	73
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	75

Local Governance and Service Delivery - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. C. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. D. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control.

Answer: A. Explanation: The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?

A. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. B. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. C. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. D. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by

itself evidence of functional devolution.

Answer: B. Explanation: The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?

A. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. B. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. C. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. D. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order.

Answer: C. Explanation: The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The governance question is delivery rather than constitutional status?

A. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. B. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. C. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. D. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition,

reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004.

Answer: D. Explanation: The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The three functional legs of genuine devolution?

A. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. B. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. C. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. D. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The three functional legs of genuine devolution?

A. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. B. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. C. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. D. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed

on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution.

Answer: B. Explanation: Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The three functional legs of genuine devolution?

A. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. B. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. C. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. D. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order.

Answer: C. Explanation: Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The three functional legs of genuine devolution?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. B. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. C. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. D. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity.

Answer: D. Explanation: Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?

A. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. B. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. C. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. D. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution.

Answer: A. Explanation: Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?

A. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. B. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. C. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. D. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States.

Answer: B. Explanation: Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?

A. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. B. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. C. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. D. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States.

Answer: C. Explanation: Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Article 243G, the Eleventh Schedule and its twenty-nine subjects?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. B. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. C. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. D. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control.

Answer: D. Explanation: Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?

A. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. B. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. C. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. D. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?

A. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. B. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. C. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. D. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?

A. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. B. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. C. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. D. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Twelfth Schedule and its eighteen municipal functions?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. B. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. C. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. D. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Activity mapping completed on paper?

A. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. B. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. C. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. D. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice.

Answer: A. Explanation: Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Activity mapping completed on paper?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. B. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. C. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. D. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer.

Answer: B. Explanation: Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Activity mapping completed on paper?

A. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. B. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. C. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. D. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice.

Answer: C. Explanation: Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Activity mapping completed on paper?

A. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. B. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. C. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. D. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution.

Answer: D. Explanation: Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?

A. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. B. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. C. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. D. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States.

Answer: A. Explanation: Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?

A. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. B. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. C. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. D. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice.

Answer: B. Explanation: Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?

A. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. B. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. C. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. D. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented.

Answer: C. Explanation: Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Parastatal encroachment and the work-order test?

A. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. B. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. C. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. D. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order.

Answer: D. Explanation: Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?

A. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. B. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. C. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. D. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice.

Answer: A. Explanation: The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?

A. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. B. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. C. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. D. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body.

Answer: B. Explanation: The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of

their recommendations are irregular in several States. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?

A. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. B. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. C. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. D. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body.

Answer: C. Explanation: The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Funds, own revenue and the State Finance Commission?

A. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. B. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. C. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. D. The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States.

Answer: D. Explanation: The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. The remaining options belong to different chronology,

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. B. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. C. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. D. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(b) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?

A. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. B. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. C. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. D. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body.

Answer: B. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(a) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions,

for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?

A. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. B. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. C. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. D. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented.

Answer: C. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280?

A. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. B. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. C. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. D. Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice.

Answer: D. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(a) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?

A. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. B. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. C. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. D. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body.

Answer: A. Explanation: Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?

A. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. B. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. C. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. D. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?

A. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. B. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. C. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. D. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Functionary control as the least visible and most decisive leg?

A. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. B. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. C. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. D. Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer.

Answer: D. Explanation: Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?

A. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. B. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. C. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. D. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality.

Answer: A. Explanation: Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?

A. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. B. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. C. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. D. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in

the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?

A. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. B. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. C. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. D. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas.

Answer: C. Explanation: Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The District Planning Committee under Article 243ZD?

A. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. B. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. C. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. D. Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and

Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body.

Answer: D. Explanation: Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?

A. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. B. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. C. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. D. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure.

Answer: A. Explanation: Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?

A. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. B. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. C. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. D. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no

percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?

A. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. B. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. C. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. D. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Metropolitan Planning Committee under Article 243ZE?

A. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. B. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. C. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. D. Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented.

Answer: D. Explanation: Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?

A. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. B. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. C. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. D. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas.

Answer: A. Explanation: State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?

A. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. B. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. C. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. D. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation.

Answer: B. Explanation: State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?

A. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. B. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. C. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. D. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation.

Answer: C. Explanation: State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about State Election Commissions and the continuity precondition?

A. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. B. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. C. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. D. State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality.

Answer: D. Explanation: State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?

A. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. B. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. C. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. D. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?

A. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. B. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. C. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. D. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?

A. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. B. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. C. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. D. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 and the consultation limit?

A. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. B. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and

resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 extends the Panchayat provisions to Fifth Schedule areas with Gram Sabha powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution, and it is the strongest statutory recognition of community authority in Scheduled Areas, but the precision that matters is that it requires consultation before land acquisition and resettlement in Scheduled Areas rather than a universal consent requirement, and it applies to Scheduled Areas rather than to all tribal-majority areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?

A. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. B. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. C. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. D. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?

A. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. B. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. C. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. D. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional

recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?

A. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. B. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. C. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. D. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 as the benchmark?

A. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the

revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. B. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?

A. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. B. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. C. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. D. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch.

Answer: A. Explanation: Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?

A. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. B. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. C. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. D. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?

A. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. B. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. C. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. D. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce

unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained.

Answer: C. Explanation: Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Deconcentration, delegation and devolution?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer.

Answer: D. Explanation: Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?

A. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. B. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch.

Answer: A. Explanation: The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?

A. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. B. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital

budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well.

Answer: B. Explanation: The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. C. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. D. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The devolution gap and the asymmetry finding?

A. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. B. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. C. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. D. The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies The case for rural and urban merger?

A. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. B. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. C. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no

devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. D. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well.

Answer: A. Explanation: Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under The case for rural and urban merger?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained.

Answer: B. Explanation: Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The case for rural and urban merger?

A. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. B. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. C. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. D. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004.

Answer: C. Explanation: Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The case for rural and urban merger?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. C. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. D. Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch.

Answer: D. Explanation: Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The case against merger and the middle options?

A. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. B. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained.

Answer: A. Explanation: Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under The case against merger and the middle options?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. C. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. D. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity.

Answer: B. Explanation: Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The case against merger and the middle options?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. C. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative

distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. D. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control.

Answer: C. Explanation: Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The case against merger and the middle options?

A. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. B. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. C. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. D. Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well.

Answer: D. Explanation: Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?

A. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. B. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. C. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. D. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004.

Answer: A. Explanation: Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?

A. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. B. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. C. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning

own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. D. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control.

Answer: B. Explanation: Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?

A. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. B. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. C. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. D. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity.

Answer: C. Explanation: Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Urban governance as a distinct institutional problem?

A. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. B. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. C. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. D. Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?

A. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. B. The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. C. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. D. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds

constitutional status without delivery capacity.

Answer: A. Explanation: Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?

A. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. B. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. C. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. D. Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity.

Answer: B. Explanation: Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?

A. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. B. Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. C. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. D. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution.

Answer: C. Explanation: Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Elite capture, equity trade-offs and honest question ownership?

A. Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. B. Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. C. The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. D. Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains

demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained.

Answer: D. Explanation: Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Three direct General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three applied objective demands are routed to this topic across the audited ledgers, and every routed Mains stem used below was confirmed word for word in the locally held OCR-searchable official question papers. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 demand on the shift of local institutions from their formative phase of functions, functionaries and funds to the contemporary stage of functionality, and the 2022 demand on the extent to which decentralisation of power has changed the governance landscape at the grassroots, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, so both are answered from the core file. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 demand on the role of local bodies in providing good governance at the local level and the pros and cons of merging rural local bodies with urban local bodies to this Basic owner. The audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger routes the 2021 objective demand on the Right to the City concept and the United Nations human settlements programme and the 2022 objective demand on a national sanitation coalition and the national urban-affairs institute here, and the official 2018-2023 Preliminary Examination keys are not held locally, so no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for either. The audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes the objective demand on the revamped rural self-governance scheme's objectives, duration and funding here; the 2026 Set-A key held locally is provisional, no answer letter is recorded or inferred, and no objective list, approval date, duration, outlay or Centre-State funding ratio is asserted because no official source for the revamped scheme was obtained. No official answer key or marking scheme is held locally for any routed Mains demand, so every model solution below is an authored answer route rather than an official key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the governance concept and separate it from the nearest legal, institutional or measured category. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, delegated or executive authority and the competent level of government. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline

implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map state, market, civil-society, frontline and citizen stakeholders with power, duty and vulnerability. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace finance, information, implementation, monitoring, grievance, appeal and correction through the delivery chain. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, institution, scheme, audit, reform or local example with source, date and operative status. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test exclusion, digital divide, privacy, capture, capacity, indicator gaming, trade-off and residual-risk limits. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: 2024 Q5: "Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at local level

and bring out the pros and cons of merging the rural local bodies with the urban local bodies." - structure the answer as (a) local bodies' good-governance role assessed through the 3Fs framework (not a generic list of functions); (b) explicit pros of rural-urban merger (unified planning, service economies, reduced overlap); (c) explicit cons (diluted rural representation, disrupted revenue/tax base, increased administrative distance); (d) a balanced recommendation (e.g., functional/service-level convergence without full administrative merger, or graduated reclassification criteria).

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	74	Revamped Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan objectives, duration, and funding	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Revamped Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan objectives, duration, and funding

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	5	Role of local bodies; merging rural and urban local bodies	Analyse · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Role of local bodies; merging rural and urban local bodies

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2021, 2022
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	Prelims GS-I	81	Right to the City concept and UN-Habitat	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	74	India Sanitation Coalition and National Institute of Urban Affairs	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Right to the City concept and UN-Habitat
- India Sanitation Coalition and National Institute of Urban Affairs

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: 2024 Q5 rewards using the 3Fs and devolution-gap diagnostic to assess local bodies'

good-governance role (rather than reciting constitutional provisions), and applying explicit merger-decision criteria (density, revenue compatibility, service mismatch) to give a genuinely balanced pros/cons analysis rather than a generic list.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-II	13	Local institutions from functions functionaries and funds to functionality	Highlight the challenges · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; service delivery and the constitutional tier both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	3	Decentralisation of power and the governance landscape at the grassroots	To what extent · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Local institutions from functions functionaries and funds to functionality
- Decentralisation of power and the governance landscape at the grassroots

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: The strength and sustenance of local institutions in India has shifted from their formative phase of Functions, Functionaries and Funds to the contemporary stage of Functionality. Highlight the critical challenges faced by local institutions in terms of their functionality in recent times. Answer in 250 words for 15 marks.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity Panchayati Raj owner, answered from the Basic owner under core routing, and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2020 General Studies Paper-II. No official answer key is held locally, so the model solution is an authored answer route.

Model solution: Highlight the critical challenges is a diagnostic directive, and the stem hands you its own structure by naming the shift from three inputs to one outcome, so the organising sentence is that funds, functions and functionaries are inputs while functionality is an outcome, and a local body can hold all three formally and still not function. Then take the challenges at the points where the conversion actually fails. The first is functions transferred on paper only, because activity mapping lists the activity while parastatal encroachment keeps it in practice, since State water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to hold the budget line and to sign the work order for services nominally devolved; the diagnostic question that settles it is who signs the work order. The second is funds without fiscal autonomy, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make the local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, own-source revenue is narrow with outdated property valuation and weak collection, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States, while Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280(3)(bb) and Article 280(3)(c) supplement and cannot substitute for these. The third is functionaries not accountable to the local body, because staff on deputation depend on the State line department for their careers, so the elected representative can request but not direct, which is the least visible of the three legs and the most decisive. The fourth is capacity, because elected representatives and staff often lack technical, planning and financial-management capability and first-time and reserved-seat representatives are least likely to receive it. The fifth is internal accountability, covering irregular village-assembly functioning, weak audit of local accounts, elite capture and the documented proxy-representation problem that hollows out reservation. The sixth is electoral continuity, because local-body elections and State Election Commissions are State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a structural risk rather than an accident. The seventh is fragmented parallel structures, because scheme-specific committees running alongside the Panchayat dilute a single accountable local authority. Add the planning layer, since Article 243ZD requires a District Planning Committee with at least four-fifths of members elected by and from the district's elected local members in proportion to rural and urban population, and its uneven operationalisation reduces integrated planning to plan compilation. Conclude that functionality requires the three legs to move together and simultaneously, because sequenced or partial devolution reliably produces the constitutional form without the capacity. Assert no devolution-index rank, no percentage of functions transferred and no State award share.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Highlight the critical challenges is a diagnostic directive, and the stem hands you its own structure by naming the shift from three inputs to one outcome, so the organising sentence is that funds, functions and functionaries are inputs while functionality is an outcome, and a local body can hold all three formally and still not function. Then take the challenges at the points where the conversion actually fails. The first is functions transferred on paper only, because activity mapping lists the activity while parastatal encroachment keeps it in practice, since State water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to hold the budget line and to sign the work order for services nominally devolved; the diagnostic question that settles it is who signs the work order. The second is funds without fiscal autonomy, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make the local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, own-source revenue is narrow with outdated property valuation and weak collection, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States, while Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280(3)(bb) and Article 280(3)(c) supplement and cannot substitute for these. The third is functionaries not accountable to the local body, because staff

on deputation depend on the State line department for their careers, so the elected representative can request but not direct, which is the least visible of the three legs and the most decisive. The fourth is capacity, because elected representatives and staff often lack technical, planning and financial-management capability and first-time and reserved-seat representatives are least likely to receive it. The fifth is internal accountability, covering irregular village-assembly functioning, weak audit of local accounts, elite capture and the documented proxy-representation problem that hollows out reservation. The sixth is electoral continuity, because local-body elections and State Election Commissions are State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a structural risk rather than an accident. The seventh is fragmented parallel structures, because scheme-specific committees running alongside the Panchayat dilute a single accountable local authority. Add the planning layer, since Article 243ZD requires a District Planning Committee with at least four-fifths of members elected by and from the district's elected local members in proportion to rural and urban population, and its uneven operationalisation reduces integrated planning to plan compilation. Conclude that functionality requires the three legs to move together and simultaneously, because sequenced or partial devolution reliably produces the constitutional form without the capacity. Assert no devolution-index rank, no percentage of functions transferred and no State award share.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Highlight the critical challenges is a diagnostic directive, and the stem hands you its own structure by naming the shift from three inputs to one outcome, so the organising sentence is that funds, functions and functionaries are inputs while functionality is an outcome, and a local body can hold all three formally and still not function. Then take the challenges at the points where the conversion actually fails. The first is functions transferred on paper only, because activity mapping lists the activity while parastatal encroachment keeps it in practice, since State water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to hold the budget line and to sign the work order for services nominally devolved; the diagnostic question that settles it is who signs the work order. The second is funds without fiscal autonomy, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make the local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, own-source revenue is narrow with outdated property valuation and weak collection, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States, while Union Finance Commission grants under Article 280(3)(bb) and Article 280(3)(c) supplement and cannot substitute for these. The third is functionaries not accountable to the local body, because staff on deputation depend on the State line department for their careers, so the elected representative can request but not direct, which is the least visible of the three legs and the most decisive. The fourth is capacity, because elected representatives and staff often lack technical, planning and financial-management capability and first-time and reserved-seat representatives are least likely to receive it. The fifth is internal accountability, covering irregular village-assembly functioning, weak audit of local accounts, elite capture and the documented proxy-representation problem that hollows out reservation. The sixth is electoral continuity, because local-body elections and State Election Commissions are State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a structural risk rather than an accident. The seventh is fragmented parallel structures, because scheme-specific committees running alongside the Panchayat dilute a single accountable local authority. Add the planning layer, since Article 243ZD requires a District Planning Committee with at least four-fifths of members elected by and from the district's elected local members in proportion to rural and urban population, and its uneven operationalisation reduces integrated planning to plan compilation. Conclude that functionality requires the three legs to move together and simultaneously, because sequenced or partial devolution reliably produces the constitutional form without the capacity. Assert no devolution-index rank, no percentage of functions transferred and no State award share.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy,

federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: To what extent, in your opinion, has the decentralisation of power in India changed the governance landscape at the grassroots? Answer in 150 words for 10 marks.

Status: Routed to this owner by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2022 General Studies Paper-II. No official answer key is held locally, so the model solution is an authored answer route.

Model solution: To what extent demands a graded answer, so the fatal move is a binary verdict in either direction and the winning move is to grade three different kinds of decentralisation separately. Concede the real change first, because an extent answer that concedes nothing is not graded: the third tier is now permanent and constitutional, elections are held regularly in most States, reservation has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office, and a formal planning architecture exists through District Planning Committees under Article 243ZD and Metropolitan Planning Committees under Article 243ZE. Then bound the claim with the single most defensible framing available, namely that political decentralisation has advanced considerably further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation. On the fiscal side, own-source revenue is narrow, State Finance Commission constitution and acceptance are irregular, and transfers are predominantly tied, so the local body executes rather than plans. On the administrative side, field staff remain answerable to State line departments for their careers and parastatal agencies retain functions, budgets and staff, so authority has moved much less than representation. Now supply the analytical instrument that makes the gradation precise: distinguish deconcentration, which is a field office of a higher tier, delegation, which is an agency function performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution, which is the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, and observe that most Indian practice sits between the first two rather than at the third. Treat wide State variation as the analytical finding rather than as an aside, because the same constitutional frame produces very different local capacity across States, and the benchmark of the 1996 Kerala People's Plan Campaign shows what moving all three legs together looks like. Close with the graded verdict: the grassroots landscape has changed decisively in representation and in the permanence of the tier, moderately in planning form, and least of all in fiscal and administrative authority, so decentralisation in India is real, incomplete and unevenly distributed. Assert no rank, percentage, representation share or revenue figure.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: To what extent demands a graded answer, so the fatal move is a binary verdict in either direction and the winning move is to grade three different kinds of decentralisation separately. Concede the real change first, because an extent answer that concedes nothing is not graded: the third tier is now permanent and constitutional, elections are held regularly in most States, reservation has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office, and a formal planning architecture exists through District Planning Committees under Article 243ZD and Metropolitan Planning Committees under Article 243ZE. Then bound the claim with the single most defensible framing available, namely that political decentralisation has advanced considerably further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation. On the fiscal side, own-source revenue is narrow, State Finance Commission constitution and acceptance are irregular, and transfers are predominantly tied, so the local body executes rather than plans. On the administrative side, field staff remain answerable to State line departments for their careers and parastatal agencies retain functions, budgets and staff, so authority has moved much less than representation. Now supply the analytical instrument that makes the gradation

precise: distinguish deconcentration, which is a field office of a higher tier, delegation, which is an agency function performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution, which is the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, and observe that most Indian practice sits between the first two rather than at the third. Treat wide State variation as the analytical finding rather than as an aside, because the same constitutional frame produces very different local capacity across States, and the benchmark of the 1996 Kerala People's Plan Campaign shows what moving all three legs together looks like. Close with the graded verdict: the grassroots landscape has changed decisively in representation and in the permanence of the tier, moderately in planning form, and least of all in fiscal and administrative authority, so decentralisation in India is real, incomplete and unevenly distributed. Assert no rank, percentage, representation share or revenue figure.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: To what extent, in your opinion, has the decentralisation of power in India changed the governance landscape at the grassroots? Answer in 150 words for 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: To what extent demands a graded answer, so the fatal move is a binary verdict in either direction and the winning move is to grade three different kinds of decentralisation separately. Concede the real change first, because an extent answer that concedes nothing is not graded: the third tier is now permanent and constitutional, elections are held regularly in most States, reservation has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office, and a formal planning architecture exists through District Planning Committees under Article 243ZD and Metropolitan Planning Committees under Article 243ZE. Then bound the claim with the single most defensible framing available, namely that political decentralisation has advanced considerably further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation. On the fiscal side, own-source revenue is narrow, State Finance Commission constitution and acceptance are irregular, and transfers are predominantly tied, so the local body executes rather than plans. On the administrative side, field staff remain answerable to State line departments for their careers and parastatal agencies retain functions, budgets and staff, so authority has moved much less than representation. Now supply the analytical instrument that makes the gradation precise: distinguish deconcentration, which is a field office of a higher tier, delegation, which is an agency function performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution, which is the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, and observe that most Indian practice sits between the first two rather than at the third. Treat wide State variation as the analytical finding rather than as an aside, because the same constitutional frame produces very different local capacity across States, and the benchmark of the 1996 Kerala People's Plan Campaign shows what moving all three legs together looks like. Close with the graded verdict: the grassroots landscape has changed decisively in representation and in the permanence of the tier, moderately in planning form, and least of all in fiscal and administrative authority, so decentralisation in India is real, incomplete and unevenly distributed. Assert no rank, percentage, representation share or revenue figure.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at local level and bring out the pros and cons merging the rural local bodies with the urban local bodies. Answer in 150 words for 10 marks.

Status: Routed to this Basic owner by the audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-II. No official answer key is held locally, so the model solution is an authored answer route.

Model solution: The stem carries two directives, so the answer must be structured in two visibly separate parts, and examiners reward explicitly labelled lists in the second part. Begin the analysis of role through the three legs rather than through a recital of assigned subjects: local bodies deliver good governance where funds, functions and functionaries move together, and the working test of that is whether the body holds the budget line and controls the staff for the service in question. Show the mechanism briefly: functions listed under Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule for Panchayats and the Twelfth Schedule for municipalities are enabling, activity mapping makes the transfer operational, and parastatal encroachment is what most often keeps the function with a State board even after formal devolution, while tied grants restrict planning and deputed staff restrict direction. State the honest finding that recognition has produced representation with only partial authority. Now the merger question, in two labelled lists. Advantages: unified planning across a functionally continuous peri-urban settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap where a village abuts a growing city, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and service standards aligned with actual density. Disadvantages: dilution of rural representation inside a larger urban body, disruption of established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, greater administrative distance from residents, possible loss of rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and the loss of the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent. Then supply the decision rule, because analyse expects a reasoned position rather than a balanced shrug: decide by population density trajectory, share of non-agricultural employment, infrastructure-sharing potential and contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and the administrative capacity of the receiving body. Offer the middle options that score well, namely functional or service-level convergence without full administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status under the constitutional scheme, and joint service authorities for specific utilities. Conclude that merger is neither reform nor retrogression in itself and that criteria-based reclassification with transitional protection is the defensible policy. Assert no rank, revenue figure or scheme outlay.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The stem carries two directives, so the answer must be structured in two visibly separate parts, and examiners reward explicitly labelled lists in the second part. Begin the analysis of role through the three legs rather than through a recital of assigned subjects: local bodies deliver good governance where funds, functions and functionaries move together, and the working test of that is whether the body holds the budget line and controls the staff for the service in question. Show the mechanism briefly: functions listed under Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule for Panchayats and the Twelfth Schedule for municipalities are enabling, activity mapping makes the transfer operational, and parastatal encroachment is what most often keeps the function with a State board even after formal devolution, while tied grants restrict planning and deputed staff restrict direction. State the honest finding that recognition has produced representation with only partial authority. Now the merger question, in two labelled lists. Advantages: unified planning across a functionally continuous peri-urban settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap where a village abuts a growing city, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and service standards aligned with actual density. Disadvantages: dilution of rural representation inside a larger urban body, disruption of established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, greater administrative distance from

residents, possible loss of rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and the loss of the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent. Then supply the decision rule, because analyse expects a reasoned position rather than a balanced shrug: decide by population density trajectory, share of non-agricultural employment, infrastructure-sharing potential and contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and the administrative capacity of the receiving body. Offer the middle options that score well, namely functional or service-level convergence without full administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status under the constitutional scheme, and joint service authorities for specific utilities. Conclude that merger is neither reform nor retrogression in itself and that criteria-based reclassification with transitional protection is the defensible policy. Assert no rank, revenue figure or scheme outlay.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at local level and bring out the pros and cons merging the rural local bodies with the urban local bodies. Answer in 150 words for 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The stem carries two directives, so the answer must be structured in two visibly separate parts, and examiners reward explicitly labelled lists in the second part. Begin the analysis of role through the three legs rather than through a recital of assigned subjects: local bodies deliver good governance where funds, functions and functionaries move together, and the working test of that is whether the body holds the budget line and controls the staff for the service in question. Show the mechanism briefly: functions listed under Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule for Panchayats and the Twelfth Schedule for municipalities are enabling, activity mapping makes the transfer operational, and parastatal encroachment is what most often keeps the function with a State board even after formal devolution, while tied grants restrict planning and deputed staff restrict direction. State the honest finding that recognition has produced representation with only partial authority. Now the merger question, in two labelled lists. Advantages: unified planning across a functionally continuous peri-urban settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap where a village abuts a growing city, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and service standards aligned with actual density. Disadvantages: dilution of rural representation inside a larger urban body, disruption of established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, greater administrative distance from residents, possible loss of rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and the loss of the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent. Then supply the decision rule, because analyse expects a reasoned position rather than a balanced shrug: decide by population density trajectory, share of non-agricultural employment, infrastructure-sharing potential and contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and the administrative capacity of the receiving body. Offer the middle options that score well, namely functional or service-level convergence without full administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status under the constitutional scheme, and joint service authorities for specific utilities. Conclude that merger is neither reform nor retrogression in itself and that criteria-based reclassification with transitional protection is the defensible policy. Assert no rank, revenue figure or scheme outlay.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2021 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Objective demand on the Right to the City concept and the United Nations human settlements programme, routed to this owner by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger.

Status: The official 2018-2023 Preliminary Examination key is not held locally, so no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred, and no institutional attribution, adoption date or membership fact is asserted beyond what the repository owners hold.

Model solution: The examinable content is the conceptual claim of a right to the city and its place in urban governance, so the safe method is to answer from the governance frame this owner holds rather than from a remembered institutional detail. State the concept as a normative claim that the city is a collective good whose planning, services and space should be shaped by and accessible to all its residents including the poorest, so that access to housing, water, sanitation, mobility and public space is framed as an entitlement of urban residence rather than as a benefit contingent on tenure, ownership or documentation. Then connect it to what this owner does hold, because that is what makes the statement testable. Its Indian institutional expression, if any, must run through the Twelfth Schedule functions of urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, public health and slum improvement, and through whether the elected municipality actually controls the budget, the staff and the implementing agency for them, which it frequently does not because development authorities and water, transport and housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets. Note the fragmentation consequence, since a right framed against the city is only as effective as the body a resident can hold to account, and in most Indian cities responsibility sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control sits with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law. Add the participation limit, because ward committees are the intended urban participatory layer and are weak in most States, and the village assembly has no urban equivalent of comparable directness. Finally apply the classification discipline that statement-based stems test: a normative concept is not a statute, a programme is not a right, and an international declaration or agenda does not by itself create a domestic legal entitlement. No option is selected, no answer letter is recorded, and no adoption date, signatory list or institutional attribution is asserted.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2021 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The examinable content is the conceptual claim of a right to the city and its place in urban governance, so the safe method is to answer from the governance frame this owner holds rather than from a remembered institutional detail. State the concept as a normative claim that the city is a collective good whose planning, services and space should be shaped by and accessible to all its residents including the poorest, so that access to housing, water, sanitation, mobility and public space is framed as an entitlement of urban residence rather than as a benefit contingent on tenure, ownership or documentation. Then connect it to what this owner does hold, because that is what makes the statement testable. Its Indian institutional expression, if any, must run through the Twelfth Schedule functions of urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, public health and slum improvement, and through whether the elected municipality actually controls the budget, the staff and the implementing agency for them, which it frequently does not because development authorities and water, transport and housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets. Note the fragmentation consequence, since a right framed against the city is only as effective as the body a resident can hold to account, and in most Indian cities responsibility sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control sits with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law. Add the participation limit, because ward committees are the intended urban participatory layer and are weak in most States, and the village assembly has no urban equivalent of comparable

directness. Finally apply the classification discipline that statement-based stems test: a normative concept is not a statute, a programme is not a right, and an international declaration or agenda does not by itself create a domestic legal entitlement. No option is selected, no answer letter is recorded, and no adoption date, signatory list or institutional attribution is asserted.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2021 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I
Analysis: Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Objective demand on the Right to the City concept and the United Nations human settlements programme, routed to this owner by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The examinable content is the conceptual claim of a right to the city and its place in urban governance, so the safe method is to answer from the governance frame this owner holds rather than from a remembered institutional detail. State the concept as a normative claim that the city is a collective good whose planning, services and space should be shaped by and accessible to all its residents including the poorest, so that access to housing, water, sanitation, mobility and public space is framed as an entitlement of urban residence rather than as a benefit contingent on tenure, ownership or documentation. Then connect it to what this owner does hold, because that is what makes the statement testable. Its Indian institutional expression, if any, must run through the Twelfth Schedule functions of urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, public health and slum improvement, and through whether the elected municipality actually controls the budget, the staff and the implementing agency for them, which it frequently does not because development authorities and water, transport and housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets. Note the fragmentation consequence, since a right framed against the city is only as effective as the body a resident can hold to account, and in most Indian cities responsibility sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control sits with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law. Add the participation limit, because ward committees are the intended urban participatory layer and are weak in most States, and the village assembly has no urban equivalent of comparable directness. Finally apply the classification discipline that statement-based stems test: a normative concept is not a statute, a programme is not a right, and an international declaration or agenda does not by itself create a domestic legal entitlement. No option is selected, no answer letter is recorded, and no adoption date, signatory list or institutional attribution is asserted.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2021 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2022 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Objective demand on a national sanitation coalition and the national urban-affairs institute, routed to this owner by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger.

Status: The official 2018-2023 Preliminary Examination key is not held locally, so no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred, and no founding date, membership, funding or programme detail is asserted for either body named in the stem.

Model solution: The examinable skill is classifying urban institutional actors correctly, so the safe method is to test each statement against the actor taxonomy this owner holds rather than against a remembered organisational fact. Apply four distinctions. First, distinguish a constitutional or statutory local authority from a State parastatal, from a Union or State research and capacity institution, and from a multi-stakeholder coalition or non-governmental platform, because only the first has a territorial mandate and a citizen who can vote it out, while a coalition or platform convenes actors and cannot deliver a service or exercise a statutory power. Second, distinguish knowledge and capacity functions such as research, training, benchmarking, standards support and technical assistance from executive functions such as licensing, tariff setting, works execution and enforcement, and note that an institute performing the former does not thereby acquire the latter. Third, apply the sanitation-specific mapping: sanitation and solid-waste management are Twelfth Schedule municipal functions, so the accountable body remains the elected urban local body even where a State board, a coalition, a corporate-responsibility partner or a specialised agency finances, designs or operates part of the chain, and a statement transferring accountability to a partner misdescribes the design. Fourth, apply the funding and status test, since a body may be autonomous, government-supported, industry-convened or entirely voluntary, and its status determines whether its outputs are advisory or binding. Add the caution this owner enforces throughout: no membership count, founding date, funding pattern or programme outlay is asserted for any such body, because those are exactly the values a statement-based question manipulates and none is held here. No option is selected and no answer letter is recorded.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2022 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The examinable skill is classifying urban institutional actors correctly, so the safe method is to test each statement against the actor taxonomy this owner holds rather than against a remembered organisational fact. Apply four distinctions. First, distinguish a constitutional or statutory local authority from a State parastatal, from a Union or State research and capacity institution, and from a multi-stakeholder coalition or non-governmental platform, because only the first has a territorial mandate and a citizen who can vote it out, while a coalition or platform convenes actors and cannot deliver a service or exercise a statutory power. Second, distinguish knowledge and capacity functions such as research, training, benchmarking, standards support and technical assistance from executive functions such as licensing, tariff setting, works execution and enforcement, and note that an institute performing the former does not thereby acquire the latter. Third, apply the sanitation-specific mapping: sanitation and solid-waste management are Twelfth Schedule municipal functions, so the accountable body remains the elected urban local body even where a State board, a coalition, a corporate-responsibility partner or a specialised agency finances, designs or operates part of the chain, and a statement transferring accountability to a partner misdescribes the design. Fourth, apply the funding and status test, since a body may be autonomous, government-supported, industry-convened or entirely voluntary, and its status determines whether its outputs are advisory or binding. Add the caution this owner enforces throughout: no membership count, founding date, funding pattern or programme outlay is asserted for any such body, because those are exactly the values a statement-based question manipulates and none is held here. No option is selected and no answer letter is recorded.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2022 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I

Analysis: Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Objective demand on a national sanitation coalition and the national urban-affairs institute, routed to this owner by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The examinable skill is classifying urban institutional actors correctly, so the safe method is to test each statement against the actor taxonomy this owner holds rather than against a remembered organisational fact. Apply four distinctions. First, distinguish a constitutional or statutory local authority from a State parastatal, from a Union or State research and capacity institution, and from a multi-stakeholder coalition or non-governmental platform, because only the first has a territorial mandate and a citizen who can vote it out, while a coalition or platform convenes actors and cannot deliver a service or exercise a statutory power. Second, distinguish knowledge and capacity functions such as research, training, benchmarking, standards support and technical assistance from executive functions such as licensing, tariff setting, works execution and enforcement, and note that an institute performing the former does not thereby acquire the latter. Third, apply the sanitation-specific mapping: sanitation and solid-waste management are Twelfth Schedule municipal functions, so the accountable body remains the elected urban local body even where a State board, a coalition, a corporate-responsibility partner or a specialised agency finances, designs or operates part of the chain, and a statement transferring accountability to a partner misdescribes the design. Fourth, apply the funding and status test, since a body may be autonomous, government-supported, industry-convened or entirely voluntary, and its status determines whether its outputs are advisory or binding. Add the caution this owner enforces throughout: no membership count, founding date, funding pattern or programme outlay is asserted for any such body, because those are exactly the values a statement-based question manipulates and none is held here. No option is selected and no answer letter is recorded.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2022 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2026 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Objective demand on the revamped rural self-governance scheme's objectives, duration and funding, routed to this owner by the audited 2026 Prelims ledger.

Status: The 2026 Set-A key held locally is provisional, so no answer letter is recorded or inferred, and no objective list, approval date, scheme duration, outlay or Centre-State funding ratio is asserted, because no official source for the revamped scheme was obtained during this generation.

Model solution: This is a deliberately bounded gap, recorded openly rather than filled by invention, and what this owner can legitimately supply is the durable governance frame within which such a scheme sits. Place the scheme type first: a rural self-governance capacity scheme belongs to the capacity-building leg of devolution rather than to the funds or functions legs, and its characteristic components are training of elected representatives and functionaries, support for the preparation of Gram Panchayat development plans, institutional infrastructure such as Panchayat buildings and connectivity, and the strengthening of State training institutions. Then place its fiscal type: schemes of this class are typically Centrally Sponsored Schemes, which means the cost is shared between the Union and the States under a ratio fixed in the scheme guidelines with a separate and generally more favourable ratio for North-Eastern and Himalayan States and for Union Territories, and the operative consequence is that a Union

approval alone does not produce implementation because the State must budget its share and run the delivery machinery. Then apply the analytical test the owner enforces on any capacity scheme: training completion is an output, and the outcome is whether plans improve, whether devolved functions are actually exercised and whether the three legs move together, so a statement asserting improved local governance from a training figure is an output-outcome error. Finally state the boundary explicitly. No objective list, approval date, duration, outlay or funding ratio is asserted here, because no official source for the revamped scheme was obtained during this generation and the key held locally is provisional, so any figure must be verified against the Ministry of Panchayati Raj before use. No option is selected and no answer letter is recorded.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2026 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: This is a deliberately bounded gap, recorded openly rather than filled by invention, and what this owner can legitimately supply is the durable governance frame within which such a scheme sits. Place the scheme type first: a rural self-governance capacity scheme belongs to the capacity-building leg of devolution rather than to the funds or functions legs, and its characteristic components are training of elected representatives and functionaries, support for the preparation of Gram Panchayat development plans, institutional infrastructure such as Panchayat buildings and connectivity, and the strengthening of State training institutions. Then place its fiscal type: schemes of this class are typically Centrally Sponsored Schemes, which means the cost is shared between the Union and the States under a ratio fixed in the scheme guidelines with a separate and generally more favourable ratio for North-Eastern and Himalayan States and for Union Territories, and the operative consequence is that a Union approval alone does not produce implementation because the State must budget its share and run the delivery machinery. Then apply the analytical test the owner enforces on any capacity scheme: training completion is an output, and the outcome is whether plans improve, whether devolved functions are actually exercised and whether the three legs move together, so a statement asserting improved local governance from a training figure is an output-outcome error. Finally state the boundary explicitly. No objective list, approval date, duration, outlay or funding ratio is asserted here, because no official source for the revamped scheme was obtained during this generation and the key held locally is provisional, so any figure must be verified against the Ministry of Panchayati Raj before use. No option is selected and no answer letter is recorded.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2026 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I
Analysis: Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Objective demand on the revamped rural self-governance scheme's objectives, duration and funding, routed to this owner by the audited 2026 Prelims ledger. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: This is a deliberately bounded gap, recorded openly rather than filled by invention, and what this owner can legitimately supply is the durable governance frame within which such a scheme sits. Place the scheme type first: a rural self-governance capacity scheme belongs to the capacity-building leg of devolution rather than to the funds or functions legs, and its characteristic components are training of elected representatives and functionaries, support for the preparation of Gram Panchayat development plans, institutional infrastructure such as Panchayat buildings and connectivity, and the strengthening of State training institutions. Then place its fiscal type:

schemes of this class are typically Centrally Sponsored Schemes, which means the cost is shared between the Union and the States under a ratio fixed in the scheme guidelines with a separate and generally more favourable ratio for North-Eastern and Himalayan States and for Union Territories, and the operative consequence is that a Union approval alone does not produce implementation because the State must budget its share and run the delivery machinery. Then apply the analytical test the owner enforces on any capacity scheme: training completion is an output, and the outcome is whether plans improve, whether devolved functions are actually exercised and whether the three legs move together, so a statement asserting improved local governance from a training figure is an output-outcome error. Finally state the boundary explicitly. No objective list, approval date, duration, outlay or funding ratio is asserted here, because no official source for the revamped scheme was obtained during this generation and the key held locally is provisional, so any figure must be verified against the Ministry of Panchayati Raj before use. No option is selected and no answer letter is recorded.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2026 Preliminary Examination General Studies Paper-I", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at the local level. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Local bodies deliver good governance only where funds, functions and functionaries move together, so the analysis must run through the three legs and the parastatal test rather than through a list of assigned subjects, and the honest finding is representation without proportionate authority.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004.
- Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity.
- Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order.
- The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation.

Qualified conclusion: Local bodies deliver good governance only where funds, functions and functionaries move together, so the analysis must run through the three legs and the parastatal test rather than through a list of assigned subjects, and the honest finding is representation without proportionate authority.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on “Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at the local level. Answer in...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Local bodies deliver good governance only where funds, functions and functionaries move together, so the analysis must run through the three legs and the parastatal test rather than through a list of assigned subjects, and the honest finding is representation without proportionate authority.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response.

Qualification: State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Genuine devolution requires funds meaning own-source revenue and predictable formula-based transfers, functions meaning subjects actually transferred in practice rather than merely listed in a State law, and functionaries meaning staff genuinely accountable to and controlled by the local body rather than merely deputed while remaining answerable to a State department, and without all three moving together a local body holds constitutional status without delivery capacity. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Local bodies deliver good governance only where funds, functions and functionaries move together, so the analysis must run through the three legs and the parastatal test rather than through a list of assigned subjects, and the honest finding is representation without proportionate authority.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at the local level. Answer in...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: To what extent has the decentralisation of power in India changed the governance landscape at the grassroots? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The extent is real in representation, partial in planning form and least in fiscal and administrative authority, so a graded answer separates political from fiscal and administrative decentralisation and uses the deconcentration, delegation and devolution distinction rather than returning a binary verdict.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer.
- The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation.
- State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality.
- Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer.

Qualified conclusion: The extent is real in representation, partial in planning form and least in fiscal and administrative authority, so a graded answer separates political from fiscal and administrative decentralisation and uses the deconcentration, delegation and devolution distinction rather than returning a binary verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “To what extent has the decentralisation of power in India changed the governance landscape at...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The extent is real in representation, partial in planning form and least in fiscal and administrative authority, so a graded answer separates political from fiscal and administrative decentralisation and uses the deconcentration, delegation and devolution distinction rather than returning a binary verdict.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Deconcentration means field offices of a higher tier operating locally, delegation means agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier, and devolution means the transfer of authority together with resources and accountability, so most Indian practice sits between the first two, and using the three-way distinction is the cleanest way to convert an extent demand into a graded rather than a binary answer. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The single most useful diagnostic is the gap between constitutional recognition and actual devolution, and the defensible national finding is that political decentralisation has advanced further than fiscal and administrative decentralisation, since a permanent constitutional third tier, regular elections in most States, reservation that has brought large numbers of women and Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives into public office and a formal planning architecture coexist with partial fiscal and administrative authority and wide State variation. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The extent is real in representation, partial in planning form and least in fiscal and administrative authority, so a graded answer separates political from fiscal and administrative decentralisation and uses the deconcentration, delegation and devolution distinction rather than returning a binary verdict.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "To what extent has the decentralisation of power in India changed the governance landscape at...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Highlight the challenges that stand between the three functional legs of devolution and the actual functionality of local institutions. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The three legs are inputs while functionality is an outcome, so the challenges must be named at the points where the conversion fails, namely functions retained by parastatals, tied funds without fiscal autonomy, functionaries whose careers depend elsewhere, missing capacity, weak internal accountability, interrupted electoral continuity and fragmented parallel structures.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution.
- Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order.
- The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States.
- Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer.
- State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality.
- Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere, and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained.

Qualified conclusion: The three legs are inputs while functionality is an outcome, so the challenges must be named at the points where the conversion fails, namely functions retained by parastatals, tied funds without fiscal autonomy, functionaries whose careers depend elsewhere, missing capacity, weak internal accountability, interrupted electoral continuity and fragmented parallel structures.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Highlight the challenges that stand between the three functional legs of devolution and the...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The three legs are inputs while functionality is an outcome, so the challenges must be named at the points where the conversion fails, namely functions retained by parastatals, tied funds without fiscal autonomy, functionaries whose careers depend elsewhere, missing capacity, weak internal accountability, interrupted electoral continuity and fragmented parallel structures.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Activity mapping is the formal exercise of listing which specific activity within a devolved subject belongs to which tier of local government, and it is what makes the transfer of a subject operationally meaningful, yet it has been widely completed on paper without matching fund and functionary transfer, so activity mapping alone is a necessary formal step and never by itself evidence of functional devolution. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Parastatal encroachment is the well-documented pattern in which State boards and authorities such as water boards, housing boards and development authorities continue to exercise functions nominally devolved to local bodies, hollowing out the local government's practical delivery role even where the statutory devolution appears complete, and the concrete diagnostic question that exposes it is who holds the budget line and signs the work order. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The funds leg depends on own-source revenue, on State Finance Commission recommendations for the devolution of State revenue to local bodies, and on the balance between tied and untied grants, because predominantly tied and project-specific grants make a local body an executing agency rather than a planning authority, and the constitution of State Finance Commissions and the acceptance of their recommendations are irregular in several States. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Functionary control decides whether an elected local representative can direct the staff executing a devolved function or merely request it, because field staff such as engineers, health workers and teachers frequently remain administratively controlled by State line departments on whom their careers depend, and this is the least visible of the three legs, the least frequently written about and the most decisive, which makes naming it a differentiating move in an answer. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** State Election Commissions conduct local-body elections and regular elections are the precondition of local accountability, but election timing is State-controlled, so delay and prolonged administrator rule are a recurring structural risk to functionality rather than an occasional administrative accident, and this belongs in any answer on the challenges to local-institution functionality. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Devolving decisions to a village or ward can transfer them to locally dominant groups, and the correctives are rotation, reservation, disclosure, external facilitation and social audit, while reservation itself has changed who holds office more than who exercises authority in some places, which must be stated as a documented governance concern rather than as a statistic; equalising transfers remain a centralising instrument used for an equity purpose because local bodies with unequal own-revenue bases produce unequal services, and small units are close to citizens while too small for efficient infrastructure. On ownership, the audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper-II Mains demands and three objective demands to this owner, no devolution-index rank, devolved percentage, local-body revenue figure or scheme outlay is asserted anywhere,

and the objectives, duration, outlay and funding ratio of the revamped rural self-governance scheme are deliberately left unstated because no official source for them was obtained. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The three legs are inputs while functionality is an outcome, so the challenges must be named at the points where the conversion fails, namely functions retained by parastatals, tied funds without fiscal autonomy, functionaries whose careers depend elsewhere, missing capacity, weak internal accountability, interrupted electoral continuity and fragmented parallel structures.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Highlight the challenges that stand between the three functional legs of devolution and the...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine why constitutional recognition of local bodies has not by itself produced local service-delivery capacity. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Recognition establishes a permanent third tier and leaves every operative decision to State law, activity mapping, fund design and functionary control, so the devolution gap is a State-level implementation variable rather than a constitutional defect, and the benchmark case shows what closing it requires.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004.
- Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control.
- The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it.
- The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure.

Qualified conclusion: Recognition establishes a permanent third tier and leaves every operative decision to State law, activity mapping, fund design and functionary control, so the devolution gap is a State-level implementation variable rather than a constitutional defect, and the benchmark case shows what closing it requires.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on “Examine why constitutional recognition of local bodies has not by itself produced local...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Recognition establishes a permanent third tier and leaves every operative decision to State law, activity mapping, fund design and functionary control, so the devolution gap is a State-level implementation variable rather than a constitutional defect, and the benchmark case shows what closing it requires.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The constitutional recognition of local bodies is necessary and not sufficient, so the question this topic owns is whether devolution actually delivers services, while the composition, reservation and constitutional-status detail of the amendments that created the third tier is owned by Polity; the Ministry of Panchayati Raj's own official website, read on 2 September 2026, states that with the passing of the seventy-third and seventy-fourth amendment Acts of the Constitution in 1993 the division of powers and functions was extended to local self-governments so that India's federal system now works at three levels rather than two, and that the Ministry itself was established in May 2004. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response.

Qualification: State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule supplies the constitutional devolution frame for Panchayats across twenty-nine listed subjects and therefore supplies the rural functional domain against which actual activity mapping is tested, but the Schedule is enabling rather than self-executing, so State law and the real transfer of funds and staff decide operational control. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Kerala People's Plan Campaign of 1996 combined substantial devolution of plan resources with participatory local planning, genuine functional transfer and capacity-building support, and it is the benchmark demonstration that the three legs moving together produce results, which is also why its success cannot be attributed to fund devolution alone; no percentage of plan outlay is attached to it here because a dated official source would be required for any such figure. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response.

Qualification: State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Recognition establishes a permanent third tier and leaves every operative decision to State law, activity mapping, fund design and functionary control, so the devolution gap is a State-level implementation variable rather than a constitutional defect, and the benchmark case shows what closing it requires.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine why constitutional recognition of local bodies has not by itself produced local...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the pros and cons of merging rural local bodies with urban local bodies and propose a defensible decision rule. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Merger is neither reform nor retrogression in itself because it answers a genuine peri-urban service mismatch while costing rural voice and fiscal continuity, so the defensible position is criteria-based reclassification with transitional protection and the availability of service-level convergence short of administrative merger.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch.
- Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well.
- Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions.
- Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body.

Qualified conclusion: Merger is neither reform nor retrogression in itself because it answers a genuine peri-urban service mismatch while costing rural voice and fiscal continuity, so the defensible position is criteria-based reclassification with transitional protection and the availability of service-level convergence short of administrative

merger.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the pros and cons of merging rural local bodies with urban local bodies and propose a...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Merger is neither reform nor retrogression in itself because it answers a genuine peri-urban service mismatch while costing rural voice and fiscal continuity, so the defensible position is criteria-based reclassification with transitional protection and the availability of service-level convergence short of administrative merger.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Merger of a rural local body with an adjoining urban local body offers unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement, economies of scale in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport, elimination of jurisdictional overlap in peri-urban areas, access to urban-scale financing and technical capacity, and better alignment of service standards with actual density, which is a genuine service-delivery answer to a genuine peri-urban mismatch. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Merger dilutes rural representation inside a larger urban body, disrupts established local revenue and tax arrangements often with a higher tax incidence on former rural residents, increases administrative distance from residents, can remove rural-specific entitlements and scheme eligibility tied to rural classification, and removes the village assembly as a direct-democracy forum for which municipal ward committees are not an equivalent; the decision should therefore be made on criteria of density trajectory, non-agricultural employment share, infrastructure contiguity, revenue-base compatibility and receiving-body capacity, and the middle options of service-level convergence without administrative merger, graduated reclassification with a transition period, transitional-area status and joint service authorities score well. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Article 243ZD requires the consolidation of Panchayat and Municipality plans and the preparation of a draft district plan, taking account of common interests such as spatial planning, sharing of water and other physical and natural resources, infrastructure and environmental conservation, with at least four-fifths of the members elected by and from the elected members of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the district in proportion to the rural and urban population, which makes the committee a representative coordinating body rather than a State-appointed district planning department; its operationalisation is uneven and many States have not made it an effective planning body. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Merger is neither reform nor retrogression in itself because it answers a genuine peri-urban service mismatch while costing rural voice and fiscal continuity, so the defensible position is criteria-based reclassification with transitional protection and the availability of service-level convergence short of administrative merger.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess the pros and cons of merging rural local bodies with urban local bodies and propose a...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess urban local governance in India as a problem of fragmented authority rather than of missing functions. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The functions are constitutionally assigned and the authority is fragmented across a State-appointed executive, parastatal agencies holding budgets and staff, weak own revenue and thin ward-level participation, so an urban reform answer must reassemble finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than assign more functions.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it.
- Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions.
- Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented.
- Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice.

Qualified conclusion: The functions are constitutionally assigned and the authority is fragmented across a State-appointed executive, parastatal agencies holding budgets and staff, weak own revenue and thin ward-level participation, so an urban reform answer must reassemble finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than assign more functions.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess urban local governance in India as a problem of fragmented authority rather than of...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The functions are constitutionally assigned and the authority is fragmented across a State-appointed executive, parastatal agencies holding budgets and staff, weak own revenue and thin ward-level participation, so an urban reform answer must reassemble finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than assign more functions.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Twelfth Schedule lists eighteen municipal functions including urban planning, land-use regulation, water supply, sanitation, solid-waste management, roads, public health and slum improvement, and it supplies the urban functional domain against which real municipal devolution is tested, but listing a function does not prove that the municipality controls the budget, the staff or the implementing agency for it. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Urban local bodies face a distinct problem set in which political leadership commonly sits with the Mayor and council while executive and staff control may sit with a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner under State law, property tax as the principal own-source revenue is constrained by narrow bases, outdated valuation, exemptions and weak collection, municipal bonds and pooled finance are available mainly to stronger bodies with predictable own revenue, and development authorities and water, sewerage, transport or housing agencies retain functions, staff and capital budgets outside the elected body, so the urban deficit is fragmentation of finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than an absence of assigned functions. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Article 243ZE provides for a Metropolitan Planning Committee to prepare a draft development plan for a metropolitan area by integrating municipal and Panchayat plans together with common spatial, infrastructure and environmental interests, which is the constitutional answer to fragmented metropolitan planning, and its constitution and effectiveness are State-variable so no national compliance count may be invented. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Article 280(3)(bb) covers measures needed to augment the resources of Panchayats and Article 280(3)(c) the resources of Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, so Union Finance Commission local-body grants supplement weak own revenue and can attach service and accounting conditions, but they cannot substitute for regular State Finance Commissions, for own-revenue effort or for control over functionaries, and tied grants constrain local choice. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The functions are constitutionally assigned and the authority is fragmented across a State-appointed executive, parastatal agencies holding budgets and staff, weak own revenue and thin ward-level participation, so an urban reform answer must reassemble finance, functionaries, planning and answerability rather than assign more functions.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess urban local governance in India as a problem of fragmented authority rather than of...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.